Nationwide property sourcing without ATTOM

Decision brief for Pantopus. The founder’s current ATTOM bill is $0. All three options in this plan spend $0 with ATTOM.

Start with public records and no commercial property subscription. Give every U.S. user a way to enter or correct a property. Before promising a complete record, prove which facts exist for the specific parcel, building or unit and which rights allow Pantopus to show them.

What replaces the 46 rows

Supply	Rows	Decision
Public roll or geography	15	Use assessor, parcel, cadastral and government boundary files. Typical candidates include year built, stories, parcel identifiers and legal land area. Completeness varies.
Conditional public or permitted evidence	25	Request improvement cards, plats, inspections and condo schedules. Use consented manager or household evidence for gaps, clearly labeled. Examples include roof, HVAC, parking and unit interiors.
Postal destination	1	Use an independently permitted ZIP+4 or a licensed postal check. Leave the suffix unknown when the destination is unconfirmed.
Vendor-specific identifier	1	Replace ATTOM ID with Pantopus ID and public source IDs. An assessor cannot supply a new ATTOM ID.
Model outputs	4	Estimate, range, confidence and valuation date come from a qualified model. On the public-first path, omit model output unless an independently validated model or authorized appraisal supports that specific fact.

What it costs

For an initial public-data release, the planning model values setup at $47,500 and annual operations at $30,480, including labor. If the founder supplies the labor, modeled external cash is $5,400 in year one and $2,400 annually thereafter. This buys the first connectors and nationwide handling of missing records. Additional local connector work is costed separately on page 5.

46-field app serializer · 2026 nationwide geography · Assessor improvements · ATTOM residential model scope

Direct sources for every field group

“Public” identifies a possible origin. A published schema, an online viewer and the right to republish a value are separate pieces of evidence.

Screenshot section	Fields to source	First acquisition route
Building · 15	Year built, effective year built, living area, gross area, ground-floor area, stories, bedrooms, bathrooms, full baths, partial baths, fireplaces, architectural style, condition, quality, buildings on parcel.	Start with assessor improvements and their local codebooks. D.C. publishes separate residential, condo and commercial tables; King County documents first-floor area. Use exact units for room counts.
Construction / utilities · 4	Exterior walls, roof cover, heating, cooling.	D.C. publishes wall, roof and heat descriptions. A yes/no AC field supports presence only. Use permitted operator records for a unit system or later retrofit.
Parking · 4	Garage, parking type, parking spaces, parking area.	Seek assessor sketches, recorded condo allocations or operator plans. King County separates attached and basement garage areas. Parking rights, spaces and site area each need their own evidence.
Lot · 3	Lot size (acres), lot area (sq ft), lot number.	Use recorded assessor/plat values or separately labeled GIS area. Store the legal parent for rental units; distinguish platted lot number from APN.
Parcel & records · 16	Address on record, ZIP+4, APN, county, county FIPS, municipality, subdivision, tax code area, property type, class, subtype, land use, county use code, occupancy, legal description, ATTOM ID.	Use situs files, Census geography, assessor roll and legal records. ZIP+4 and ATTOM ID have separate rules. Occupancy needs an explicit permitted source and never grants residency.
Value · 4	Estimated value, estimate range, confidence score, estimate date.	Public assessment and recorded sale can be displayed with their own labels. Obtain model outputs or build and validate a model with lawful comparable sales. Missing confidence or model date stays unknown.

The workbook gives each row its own source lead, example field, scope, license decision and fallback. Public sources may charge for copies, exclude protected parcels or restrict commercial lists. Admit only no-fee, approved sources to the public-first budget.

D.C. residential CAMA · D.C. condominium CAMA · King County field dictionary · Clark County taxlot schema · USPS ZIP+4 · Washington records law

Acquire the correct legal property

Use the 2026 Census inventory as the denominator. The workbook contains 3,235 county/equivalents in 50 states, D.C., Puerto Rico and the four other inhabited U.S. territories. Each of the 56 entries has a custodian or program route.

Property class	Primary subject and gap plan
Houses and townhouses	Join the tax account, parcel and identified structure. A townhouse may be fee-simple or legally a condo. Use the proper estate for lot size, alteration history and valuation.
Condo units	Resolve an individual legal unit and its tax account before attaching beds, living area or value. Roof, exterior and common improvements belong to the building. NYC PLUTO can aggregate unit tax lots to one billing lot.
Rental units and apartment complexes	Maintain property/site, building and unit records. The public roll may support unit count and whole-building area. An exact apartment layout usually needs authorized manager plans or another independent unit source. Commercial data providers may cover only larger communities.
Offices, suites, retail and industrial	Use gross, rentable and suite area with their definitions. Identify building systems, common parking and separately assigned rights. A commercial value requires appropriate comparable, income and cap-rate evidence. A leasehold typically lacks a separate sale value.
Mixed-use, campus, mobile and vacant	Model residential and commercial components separately, each building at a campus, and land ownership apart from mobile homes/pads. For vacant land, record land facts and distinguish unknown or future improvements from real buildings.

How national acquisition works

Use statewide rolls when the state publishes them, such as Florida. Use statewide parcel compilations plus local improvements where needed, such as North Carolina or Texas. Else request assessor/recorder files from the local custodian. For territories, identify the land-registration or tax authority and verify access. Census geography never substitutes for permission or parcel coverage.

Refresh by each publisher’s cadence and original observation date. Join using jurisdiction, raw APN/account, building and unit IDs, and effective dates. Preserve leading zeros and split/merge history. A fuzzy match or the first returned property must never assign another unit’s data.

Florida state roll files · Census county index · NYC condo conventions · Multifamily product limits · Commercial underwriting

What the replacement would cost

All figures are USD. The founder's present ATTOM expense is $0; these are new costs of delivering different levels of coverage. No purchase, supplier contact or paid lookup was made.

Cost at 10,000 properties/month	Public first	Metered bridge	Bulk baseline
One-time implementation	$47,500	$55,800	$120,000
Identified annual run	$30,480	$49,904	$172,240
Identified year one	$77,980	$105,704	$292,240
External cash in year one if labor internal	$5,400	$15,424	$116,680
Identified three-year total	$138,940	$205,512	$636,720

Public first has $0 in commercial licenses. Its initial engineering/GIS work is 6/5 person-weeks. The bridge assumes 8/4; bulk assumes 16/10. Loaded hourly rates for engineering/GIS/QA are $105/$80/$55. Budgets include setup, incremental hosting, source-copy allowances, operations and QA. Rates and effort are estimates, not vendor or staffing quotes.

Exactly what the metered charge buys

Assume 30% of distinct opens need a fresh record and 70% of those need one additional eligible residential value call. At 10,000 opens that is 3,000 detail + 2,100 valuation = 5,100 API requests. RentCast Growth costs $199 for 5,000 requests plus $3 for 100 overage requests, or $202/month ($2,424/year). Consumer-display/storage rights and field coverage must still fit the actual usage.

Distinct opens per month	Bridge requests	Lowest listed monthly API cost
1,000	510	$74
10,000	5,100	$202
100,000	51,000	$839

The bulk path includes an $80,000/year national bulk starting-price allowance and 2,100 residential AVM requests per month ($140 at the listed tiers). It assumes zero metered property-detail calls for bulk-held records. Supplemental commercial/unit/rights prices are unquoted; page 5 explains how to add them.

RentCast prices · RentCast billing · RentCast license · Bulk price and scope · Labor benchmark

Where money changes coverage

Buying a national base can reduce connector work, but it does not create facts that custodians never recorded. The zero-commercial-fee alternative shifts that work to Pantopus.

Decision	Evidence and treatment
Direct public expansion	The model adds 3 engineer-days per extra source mapping at $105/hour, then 4 GIS hours per quarter at $80/hour. 100 additional mappings cost $252,000 to build and $128,000/year to maintain. At 500: $1.26 million and $640,000/year. These are sensitivities beyond the first release; one mapping may serve many counties.
National property file	PropertyLayer lists a national license from $80,000/year. Its $3,000/month pilot has an order-defined term and generally internal-use rights. Obtain consumer display, local storage, updates, derivatives, disaster recovery, suppression and exit terms in writing. First American and Cotality are alternative RFQs.
Postal suffix	USPS lists its ZIP+4 all-states reference service at $1,750/year. That line item is not an integrated postal processor or a grant of consumer-display rights. Use an existing permitted destination service, obtain a suitable contract, or omit the suffix.
Unit and CRE inventory	Prefer an authorized property manager or condominium inventory for targeted gaps. Ask a specialist for pricing by covered buildings, markets and actual unit matches; Yardi's multifamily offering describes a 50+ unit focus in covered markets. A floor-plan mix does not identify a named apartment.
Valuation and other app uses	Secure qualified output for a specific asset class or suppress it. Fees for a commercial model, increments for user-facing rights, and any owner-match/exemption/ZIP-trend inputs are outside the identified totals. Enter annual minimums, per-use costs and setup quotes in the workbook.

If remaining at $0 in commercial data spend is the requirement, choose Public first. Show dated official records and reviewed corrections, omit unsupported classes or fields, and defer a proprietary confidence score. Treat a paid source as an optional coverage improvement, never an automatic fallback that can bill the founder.

An optional in-house residential valuation feasibility study adds an illustrative $57,200 in initial labor for one property class and $51,360/year in ongoing model/GIS labor. This excludes sales-data rights and production costs. Validate on held-out sales by market before reporting a value, interval, confidence or date. A commercial-property model requires a separate scope.

National order terms · First American bulk delivery · Cotality characteristics · USPS price list · Yardi coverage · Commercial-model example

First 90 days and release gates

Nationwide access begins with one consistent lookup and a missing-data path. Measured, correctly matched records earn the coverage claim for each jurisdiction and property class.

Timing	Work	Decision gate
Days 1-10	Register sources, field definitions and allowed audiences. Keep ATTOM credentials out of the replacement runtime. Disable live refresh and prefill jobs; the founder checks any trial renewal and retention terms.	Verify zero outbound ATTOM calls during lookup, retries, background refresh and outages. The registry admits only independently permitted inputs.
Weeks 2-4	Test public connectors spanning regions and classes: Florida rolls, D.C. CAMA, NYC PLUTO, Cook improvements, North Carolina parcels and Texas appraisal-district routes. Audit territory and remote-area formats.	For each source, validate row keys, geometry/unit links, effective dates, protected records and observed field availability. Keep untested coverage unknown.
Weeks 3-8	Serve versioned snapshots from Pantopus. Switch Home/Place/AI provider names and availability gates. Verify old iOS/Android builds, web, renters, owners and the other household's view.	No privilege from a tax-name or occupancy flag. Keep property-detail edits, source corrections and authorized user-entered facts distinguishable.
Weeks 6-12	Adjudicate a held-out sample across all states and D.C., with separate territories, rural and complex-property cohorts. Seek paid quotes only for material, approved gaps.	Measure wrong-unit rate, fill, freshness, accuracy and all applicable rows correct together. A proposed ≥99.5% auto-link precision needs evidence and uncertainty by class.
Before wider claims	Resolve exemption, ZIP-trend and ownership-evidence paths separately. Load-test nearest-region reads, stale sources, provider outages, bad imports and rollback.	Proposed warm search p95 ≤150 ms, cached read p95 ≤400 ms and monthly read availability ≥99.9%. Report actuals separately from targets.

Cost decision: measure cost per eligible property receiving correct new facts, time to first useful screen, and support/review hours. A free national location search and a partial property record are useful outcomes, but neither proves full field retrieval. Leave a paid capability off when sample quality, rights or business value do not qualify.

Basis: verified public source schemas, published prices and terms as of November 5, the app's field mapping, and an independently checked Census index. No enterprise quotes, signed sample agreement, rate of API misses or nationwide field accuracy was verified. The editable workbook separates measured inputs, planning assumptions and unknown charges.

Pantopus property projection · ATTOM evaluation terms · County coverage example · Non-disclosure sales constraint